1. Reading Comprehension

Read the following passage. Then present your interpretation of its connotation in the context of the whole story it belongs to in a passage of about 4–6 sentences in length:

> "Grendel was the name of this grim demon
> haunting the marches, marauding round the heath
> and the desolate fens; he had dwelt for a time
> in misery among the banished monsters,
> Cain's clan, whom the Creator had outlawed
> And condemned as outcasts. For the killing of Abel..."
>
> — From *Beowulf*, in *The Norton Anthology*, vol. B, p. 126.

2. Writing

Write an essay of about **1,200–1,500 words** to argue for the following topic:

The world of aquatic animals in "The Trial at the Dragon King's Palace" by Nguyễn Dữ